

Specialty Masters Club

The Official Newsletter for SM students of University of Washington



December '25 Issue — Be boundless

How Specialized Masters (SM) students are shaping the future of work

Across analytics, technology, and strategy, UW's Specialized Master's students are translating classroom learning into real-world impact.

Why this issue matters?

The future of work isn't theoretical — it's being built right now by students who are:

- Applying AI & analytics to real business decisions
- Competing in high-stakes case competitions
- Partnering with industry leaders and startups
- Developing skills that are actively hiring-relevant

This issue highlights how Specialized Masters students are preparing for what's next — and shaping it.

Inside this month's issue:

Technology Landscape & Emerging Trends

What skills and tools are actually hiring-relevant in 2026

Case Competitions: Strategy & Preparation

Frameworks, timelines, and winning mindsets

Student Opinion Page

Unfiltered perspectives on AI, careers, and specialization

About the Specialty Masters Club (SMC)

Who we are, what we do, and how to get involved

The Tech Pulse: Signals from the Frontier

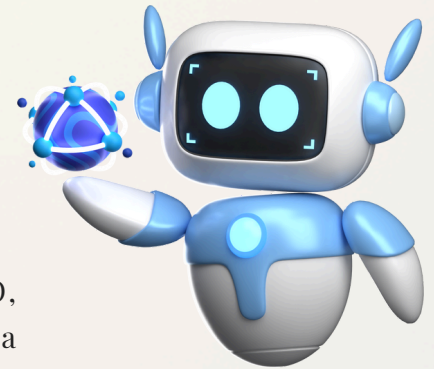
Big-tech & startups

[SpaceX Starts a Wall Street Bake-Off to Hire Banks for Possible IPO \(2-minute read\)](#)

SpaceX has begun selecting an investment bank to advise on its IPO, with banks pitching this week. The company is also planning a secondary share sale that could value it at around \$800 billion, as the US IPO market shows renewed momentum.

[Can Netflix Help Save the American Mall? \(13-minute read\)](#)

Netflix House is a permanent experiential venue combining entertainment and retail to extend popular Netflix franchises into real life. The company has opened locations in Philadelphia and Dallas and plans a third in Las Vegas in 2027.



Programming, design & data science

[How to Build Your First ChatGPT App \(11 minute read\)](#)

ChatGPT Apps let developers embed tools directly into ChatGPT, enabling tasks like booking, search, and shopping. With 800 million weekly users, the platform could become a major distribution channel, and the article explains how to build apps with examples, code, and learning resources.

[Design is search \(6 minute read\)](#)

Design is a process of exploration, not just execution. Early stages require creative freedom, while later stages demand practical constraints. Rushing these phases may speed delivery, but it sacrifices the true value of design, which isn't defined by faster technology alone.



Case Competitions (CCs): Strategy & Preparation

YOUR GUIDE TO ACING CCs

Getting started –

What Are Case Competitions? – **UNSW Business Society**
[[Link](#)]

Preparation guides

Consulting Case Competition Guide, sample presentations
and best practices – **Purdue University** [[Link](#)]

Books and resources

Case Interview Secrets – **Victor Cheng**

This is excellent for understanding how to structure,
analyze, and present, core to winning a case comp. [[Link](#)]

Practice platforms and communities

CBS Case Competition Library

A repository of past cases and finalist slide decks to study
patterns & quality of winning work
[[Link](#)]

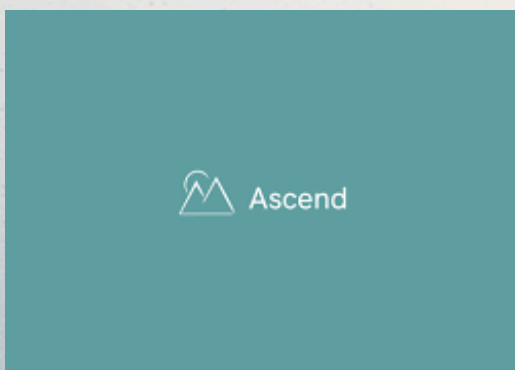


Research tools

Purdue Libraries Case Research & Data
Tools – business and industry databases
like ABI/Inform, Factiva

These help you back your solutions with
data, trends, industry context, and case
facts – crucial for credibility
[[Link](#)]

HEAR FROM YOUR PEERS



Ascend Case Comp

“The Ascend case pushed us to move beyond traditional
KPIs and ask harder questions about what truly makes a
supply chain resilient. It was a reminder that the future of
business leadership lies in combining analytical rigor with
purpose—and that’s the mindset we’re building through
this club.”

– Archit Gupta, President SMC



AI Healthcare Case Comp

“Participating in the Gilead case competition as a team of
four gave us more than a typical management case; it
offered a real-world look into pharma strategy and
decision making. One major takeaway was how important it
is to define the end objective early and build a clear
roadmap around it. Having a near-final draft ready ahead
of time helped us focus on refining the narrative instead of
scrambling with last-minute fixes. Most importantly, the
experience showed how crucial it is to keep a consistent
storyline that stays aligned with the final goal.”

– Tanishq Gupta, MSBA

Case Competitions: Upcoming Events

**SAVE
THE DATE**



Annual AI and Business Analytics Symposium

Location: In-person
(Arlington, TX)

Register by:

EARLY

JAN

[LINK](#)

Register by:

EARLY

JAN

[LINK](#)

University of Michigan Business+Tech Datathon 2026

Location: Remote and In-
person (Ann Arbor, MI)



Big Data Health Science Student Case Competition

Location: In-person
(Columbia, SC)

Register by:

JAN
01

[LINK](#)

Register by:

JAN
26

[LINK](#)

LeBow 2026 Datathon

Location: In-person
(Philadelphia, PA)





➔ AI, A Competitive Advantage



[Read More](#)

Opinion Page: How AI, analytics, and automation are reshaping roles across business functions.

Practical insights into the skills that matter most for the future workforce.

– Archit Gupta

➔ The AI Battleground

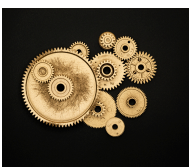


[Read More](#)

Opinion Page: Perspective on AI's rapid evolution and the importance of responsible innovation. Reflections on trust, safety, and navigating AI-driven careers with Generative AI and their emerging developments.

– Anushka Mathur

➔ GenAI / LLM Project Process Flow



[Read More](#)

A practical framework for evaluating when and how to use GenAI in real-world projects, from problem definition to production launch.

The article emphasizes MVP thinking, risk management, security, and continuous iteration for responsible AI deployment.

– Dan Blevins

YOUR MONTHLY DOPAMINE DOSE

OPINION PAGE FROM THE STUDENTS

NOTE FROM THE TEAM:

This month's Opinion Page brings together student perspectives on one of the most defining forces shaping our academic and professional futures: Artificial Intelligence.

From how AI is redefining competitive advantage across industries, to the evolving responsibilities around trust, safety, and governance, these pieces reflect the questions we are actively grappling with as Specialty Masters students at the University of Washington. Each article is grounded in real coursework, internships, research, and hands-on projects—bridging theory with practice.

Our goal with this page is simple: to create space for thoughtful, student-driven dialogue on emerging technologies and their real-world implications. Whether you're interested in analytics, product, strategy, operations, or policy, we hope these perspectives spark curiosity, conversation, and action.

As always, we encourage you to read, reflect, and continue the discussion—inside classrooms, across programs, and beyond campus.

— Specialty Masters Club

MEET THE CORE TEAM



Archit Gupta
PRESIDENT, FOUNDER



Anushka Mathur
SECRETARY, FOUNDER



Venkat Kowshik
STRATEGY



Hardik Sharma
STRATEGY



Nat
TECH AND PRODUCT



Alex
TECH AND PRODUCT



Lou
STRATEGY



Shivani Raut
OPERATIONS



Zuhaib
ALUMINI OUTREACH



Vinayak Malhotra
ALUMINI OUTREACH



Paridhi Gupta
CASE COMP



Huy
CASE COMP



Coming Soon
MARKETING & COMM



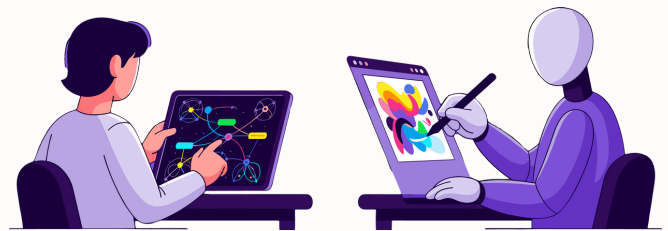
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MARKETING & COMM



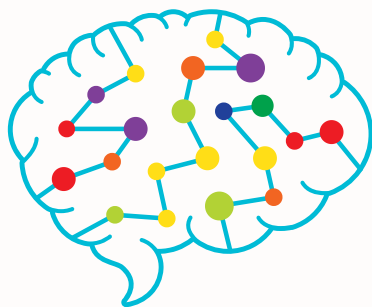
WHAT TO EXPECT AFTER THE BREAK?



SMC
RECRUITMENTS



FOSTER AI DAY
(JAN 2026)



UPCOMING CASE
COMPETITIONS



WORKSHOPS/
SMC EVENTS

WISHING YOU AND YOUR FAMILY

Happy Holidays
AND HAPPY NEW YEAR



A close-up photograph of a Christmas tree. The tree is covered in warm white lights that create a bokeh effect in the background. Several ornaments are visible, including a large white sphere, a dark brown textured sphere, a white sphere with red polka dots, and a small gold star. The text "HAPPY HOLIDAYS AND HAPPY NEW YEAR" is overlaid in the center in a white serif font.

HAPPY
HOLIDAYS
AND HAPPY NEW YEAR